Yechiel Kalmenson

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Senior Backend Engineer with nearly a decade of polyglot experience (Go, Python, Kotlin, Ruby) specializing in high-performance distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, and Open Source Software (OSS) architecture. Proven track record of building highly reliable, self-healing platforms that facilitate the large-scale management of dynamic cloud resources. A champion of Extreme Programming (XP) and observability, dedicated to balancing speed, robust CI/CD pipelines, and long-term maintainability. Drawing on a unique background in technical education, I excel at cross-team communication, unblocking complex developer workflows, and driving architectural alignment.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Rise8 | Senior Software Engineer | *April 2025 - Present*

- **Automate Release Quality:** Built Playwright end-to-end regression suites on disposable, production-like multi-service environments shared across app teams, replacing manual regression cycles with traceable, CI-gated release evidence for mission-critical satellite applications.
- **Mission-Critical Distributed Systems:** Engineered and optimized backend services for a critical satellite resource allocation system, ensuring high reliability and adherence to strict GovTech compliance and data integrity standards.
- **System Modernization & Technical Debt:** Embedded directly with engineering squads to identify design limitations, spearheading the modernization of legacy components through rigorous interactive code reviews and paired programming.
- **Engineering Velocity & Tooling:** Accelerated development velocity and augmented complex architectural decision-making by strategically integrating AI tools (Claude) into daily engineering workflows, modeling responsible usage for the broader team.

Broadcom - VMware - Pivotal Software | Software Engineer | *November 2018 - September 2024*

- **Kubernetes Operators:** Built and maintained Kubernetes operators in Go for MySQL and Postgres, delivering high-availability, self-healing database services for Tanzu and Cloud Foundry.
- **Infrastructure & Cloud Management:** Collaborated closely with the BOSH engineering team on infrastructure provisioning and lifecycle management, utilizing BOSH as an Infrastructure as Code (IaC) equivalent to automate manual operations and eliminate infrastructure toil across public cloud environments.
- **Open Source Contributor & Architect:** Spearheaded the architectural effort to port Envoy Proxy to Windows to support internal cloud infrastructure needs. This required deep practical experience with RPC frameworks, HTTP routing, and operating system internals, working alongside core maintainers from Microsoft, Google, and Lyft to merge complex PRs.
- **XP Mentorship & Technical Leadership**: Championed Extreme Programming (XP) and Test-Driven Development (TDD) across distributed teams. Ensured the delivery of high-quality, reliable code by enforcing rigorous unit and integration testing alongside clear, concise technical documentation.
- **Cloud Security & Tooling:** Led the design and development of Davos, a custom internal cloud security and CVE tracking application integrated with external scanners (Black Duck, Trivy) to automate vulnerability management and ensure platform compliance.

Newtek Business Services | Full-Stack Developer | *January 2018 - November 2018*

- Maintained legacy PHP applications, triaged bug reports, and remediated critical security vulnerabilities

Flatiron School | Technical Coach | June 2017 - September 2017

- Delivered technical education in a bootcamp setting, guiding students through full-stack coding challenges (Ruby/Rails, JavaScript, React). Utilized live screen-sharing and the Socratic method to build independent problem-solving skills.

Fidelity Payment Services | Integration Specialist & Developer Support | *June 2015 - January 2018*

- Built internal developer tools and documentation-adjacent web applications to map and track cross-platform compatibility. Raised the quality of technical documentation by translating deep architectural concepts into actionable steps to guide client engineers through complex REST API integrations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Technical experience: Typescript/Angular, Playwright, Go, Python, Kubernetes, SQL, Kotlin, Java, Ruby, C++.

Engineering Culture & Education: Pair Programming, TDD, CI/CD, Mentorship, Code Review, XP, technical writing, public speaking.

PUBLIC SPEAKING - WRITING

Technical Writing & Blogging:
Author of the active Rabbi On Rails blog where I publish tutorials, overviews, and pontificate on matters related to tech, Judaism, career, ethical AI and more.

Porting Envoy To Windows | *KubeCon* *2019* - Video | Slides
Envoy is an open source edge and service proxy, designed for cloud-native applications. For a half a year I joined Pivotal's effort to contribute a Windows implementation in collaboration with community members at Microsoft, Google, Lyft, and others. In this talk, I, together with my pair William Rowe provided a progress report on where the work was holding, and what still had to be done.

The Algorithm Ate My Homework | *RubyConf* *2021* - Video
Delivered a presentation anticipating the ethical complexities of generative AI, exploring engineering liability and responsibility for autonomous code decisions.

Talmudic Gems For Rails Developers | *RailsConf* *2021* - Video
Presented actionable frameworks for modern engineering teams, focusing on best practices for pair-programming, technical coaching, and cultivating a strong developer culture gleaned from a lifetime of talmudic study.